stability institute at the Bank for International Settlements, to head the IMF.[57] At the time, Mozhin had insisted that Russia was not just attempting "to create the appearance it is a competitive process. We strongly believe that Mr Tosovsky is the best candidate with the most relevant experience."[58]

Brazil's outspoken IMF executive director, Paulo Nogueira Batista, a Washington insider who served as one of two Latin American IMF EDs from early 2007 until his June 2015 appointment as Brazil's vice president at the NDB, similarly complained that Lagarde "is the 11th European in a row to run the IMF—it is an outdated position to reserve the managing directorship for a European." He added in remarks to *Newsweek* that a representative from one of the BRICS countries should lead the fund.[59] Meanwhile, David Lipton, first deputy managing director of the IMF, said in a July 2015 interview that once Lagarde steps aside, her successor would likely be a non-European and that the person's appointment would be "strictly merit-based." However, this will be the decision of a new U.S. administration.[60]

The 2012 election of a new World Bank president proceeded similarly to the IMF selection. In principle, the BRICS wished to support a common candidate from the developing world, but in practice, they could not. The Intergovernmental Group of Twenty-Four on International Monetary Affairs and Development (G24), a low-key coordinating committee of current and former developing country financial officials established in 1971, recruited former Colombian Finance Minister José Antonio Ocampo to run. Brazil's IMF ED Batista acted as Ocampo's campaign manager.[61] While Ocampo would draw the support of much of the Western Hemisphere, all parties understood from the beginning that his views were likely too left-leaning for the United States to accept. South Africa strongly backed neoclassical economist (and current Nigerian finance minister) Ngozi Okonjo-Iweala, while the United States nominated Korean-American university president and public health specialist Jim Yong Kim. Although Ocampo very publicly withdrew in favor of Okonjo-Iweala shortly before the official balloting, hoping to force unity among the various pro-diversity constituencies, Russia endorsed Kim, who was offered the post. In the end, 80 percent of the votes cast in the official balloting at the World Bank board went to Kim, although the African executive directors continued to support Okonjo-Iweala.

When it came time to consider a second five-year term for Kim in 2016, despite controversy over his tenure and management, Washington rushed his nomination, and he ran unopposed. Critics, who include former senior bank